Research on the Marketing Strategy of Pertamina's Pertamax Green 95 in the Indonesian Market

Evidence-Based 7Ps Strategy for Green Fuel Adoption

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School of Business Administration · Northeastern University

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PART ONE

Context & Problem: Why Pertamax Green 95 Is Stalled

Marketing activation failure — not product deficiency — drives low adoption

CONTEXT · PROBLEM DIAGNOSIS

Marketing Activation Failure Masks Operational Strength

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3.449	2.848	3.869	3.851
Overall 7Ps Mean (Moderate)	Promotion (Needs Improvement)	Process (Good)	Physical Evidence (Good)

1.021-point gap between highest (Process) and lowest (Promotion) dimension — operational excellence is invisible to the market. 44.4% of respondents unaware or never tried after 28 months.

KEY BARRIERS FROM SURVEY (n=124)

60.48%	20.97%	11.29%	7.26%
Availability & Physical Access	Price & Cost Concerns	Awareness & Information Deficit	Brand Inertia & Loyalty
Primary barrier	Income-segmented	Ad visibility 2.113	Habitual resistance

CONTEXT · 7Ps DIAGNOSTIC

Severe Internal Asymmetry: Promotion Is the Critical Bottleneck

Dimension	Mean	SD	Category	Gap
P6 Process	3.869	0.403	Good	—
P7 Physical Evidence	3.851	0.478	Good	-0.018
P5 People	3.762	0.407	Good	-0.107
P1 Product	3.603	0.445	Good	-0.266
P3 Place	3.356	0.434	Moderate	-0.513
P2 Price	3.079	0.507	Moderate	-0.790
P4 Promotion	2.848	0.577	Needs	-1.021
OVERALL	**3.449**	**0.268**	**Moderate**	**—**

P3.1 Availability at Visited Stations = 2.210 (2nd lowest)
P2.3 Value for Money = 2.637 (3rd lowest)

- Promotion failure is the foundational constraint: without awareness, distribution expansion cannot generate trial, and price incentives cannot stimulate demand.

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PART TWO

Environment Analysis: PESTEL · Five Forces · SWOT · TOWS

Favorable macro tailwinds; competitive intensity demands precise targeting

ENVIRONMENT · PESTEL MACRO ANALYSIS

Policy Tailwinds Meet Supply & Credibility Gaps

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POLITICAL

E10 mandate by 2027; Presidential Decree 15/2024; SOE alignment

Positive: regulatory demand growth | Risk: policy delay

ECONOMIC

GDP 5.03%; middle-class growth; 44% refined fuel imports; IDR volatility

Growing consumer base | Pricing flexibility constrained

SOCIAL

141M+ vehicles; rising green consciousness; national pride

Positive long-term | Near-term price sensitivity dominates

TECHNOLOGICAL

E10 trial underway; digital gap (MyPertamina); EV targets 2030

Production advantage | Digital infrastructure deficit

ENVIRONMENTAL

Net-zero 2060; NDC targets; feedstock supply constraints

Policy legitimacy | Credibility & supply gaps

LEGAL

E5 codified (ESDM 252/2023); MOPS pricing; Euro 4/5; E10 pending

Compliance market | Pricing & investment uncertainty

ENVIRONMENT · PORTER'S FIVE FORCES · SWOT

High Rivalry & Buyer Power; Promotional Weakness Is Primary Constraint

Competitive Rivalry	**HIGH**	Shell V-Power (200 stations); subsidized fuel substitution; weak differentiation
New Entrants	**LOW–MODERATE**	High capital/regulatory barriers; indirect EV/charging threat
Supplier Power	**MODERATE**	Strong petroleum; fragmented bioethanol; no ethanol subsidy
Buyer Power	**HIGH**	Low switching costs; high price sensitivity; fuel is credence good
Substitutes	**MODERATE–HIGH**	Direct: lower-tier fuels; Indirect: EVs, public transport, ride-hailing

SWOT HIGHLIGHTS

STRENGTHS

S1: First-mover E5, LEMIGAS-certified
S2: E10 trial technical lead
S3: 6,000+ stations (30× Shell)
S4: SOE regulatory alignment
S5: Frontline service quality
S6: Regulation-backed environmental authenticity

WEAKNESSES

W1: No dedicated ad campaign
W2: 177 of 6,000+ stations (Java-only)
W3: Price-value perception gap
W4: MyPertamina app underperforming
W5: Staff lack product knowledge
W6: Green claims lack verified evidence

OPPORTUNITIES

O1: E10 mandate 2027 → regulatory demand
O2: Growing green consciousness (25–44)
O3: 22.6% aware non-triers to convert
O4: Turbo/high-compression engine growth
O5: Government ethanol investment
O6: Middle-class income growth 5%+

THREATS

T1: EV adoption (2M 2W by 2030)
T2: Shell/BP superior marketing
T3: Bioethanol supply gap (160K vs 4B L)
T4: E10 regulation pending; reversal risk
T5: Subsidized fuel substitution
T6: Rupiah volatility; import cost pressure

ENVIRONMENT · TOWS STRATEGY MATRIX

Four Strategic Pathways: Promotional Failure Is the Foundational Constraint

SO (Strengths + Opportunities)	WO (Weaknesses + Opportunities)	ST (Strengths + Threats)	WT (Weaknesses + Threats)
Leverage product certification & station network to capture E10 mandate market. Use SOE status for government fleet contracts.	Use digital marketing & sustainability trends to overcome promotional weakness. Partner with EV manufacturers for hybrid positioning.	Use RON 95 certification & LEMIGAS validation to differentiate against Shell V-Power. Accelerate E10 readiness to maintain regulatory advantage.	Develop bioethanol supply chain resilience. Build digital consumer engagement before EV substitution accelerates gasoline demand decline.

- Promotional failure (W1) is the primary constraint: without resolving it, SO strategies around product certification and distribution expansion yield suboptimal returns — consumers remain unaware of improved availability or quality.

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PART THREE

Strategy Design: STP + Integrated 7P Marketing Mix

Three-stage logic: Diagnostic → TOWS Match → STP Target → 7P Execution

STRATEGY · STP: SEGMENTATION & TARGETING

Primary Target: Green-Affluent Urban Professionals (25–44, 10–50M IDR, High Eco-Concern)

Green-Affluent Urban Professionals

16.13% share | 45% usage
Age 25–44 | 10–50M IDR
High eco-concern | Digital-native

PRIMARY TARGET

Eco-Activist Early Adopters

26.61% share | 42% usage
All ages | Very high eco-concern
Availability/awareness gaps

RETENTION FOCUS

Conservative Established Users

5.65% share | 57% usage
Age 35–54 | >20M IDR
Moderate eco-concern
Need performance evidence

CONVERSION TARGET

Price-Sensitive Young Commuters

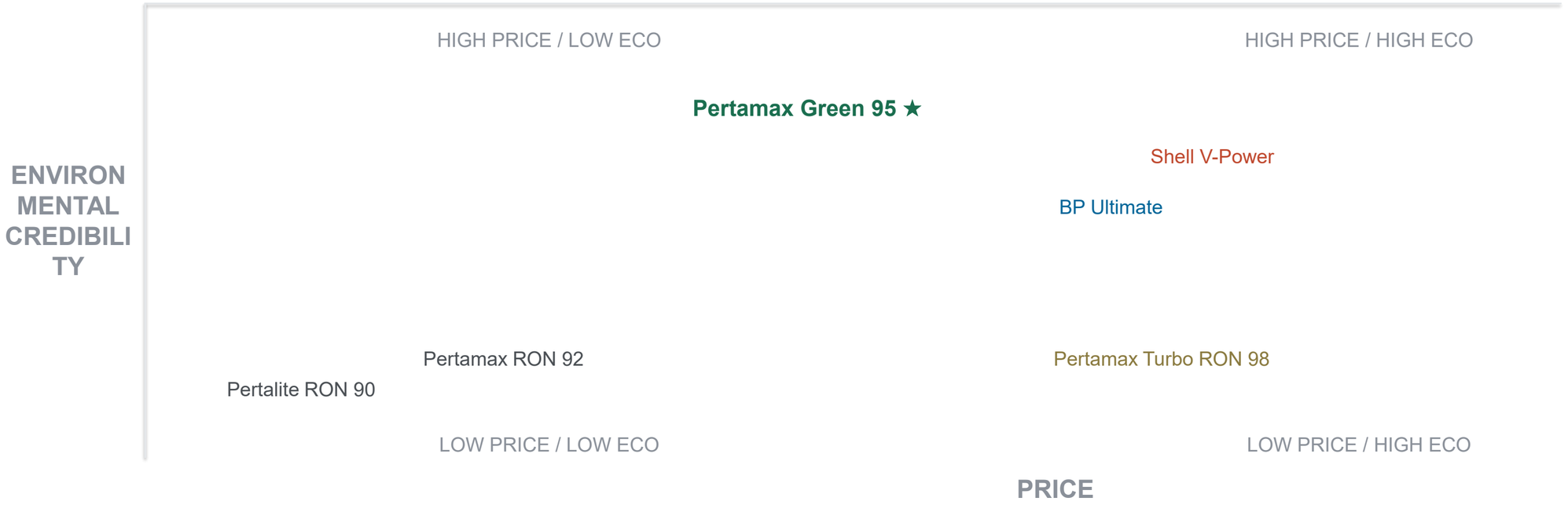
2.42% share | 33% usage
Age 18–34 | <10M IDR
Motorcycle-dominant
Price incentives required

BROAD TACTICS

TARGETING PRIORITY: Retention (54% current users) → Conversion (22.6% aware non-triers) → Acquisition (~15% unaware eco-concerned)

STRATEGY · POSITIONING

Uncontested 'Green Premium': Certified RON 95 + Verified Eco-Benefits at Mid-Market Price



For environmentally conscious Indonesian vehicle owners aged 25–44 with household income above 10M IDR, Pertamax Green 95 is the premium fuel that delivers certified RON 95 engine performance while reducing carbon emissions through 5% bioethanol from Indonesian sugarcane. Unlike conventional Pertamax or imported alternatives, Pertamax Green 95 offers independently verified environmental impact transparency combined with national agricultural community support.

STRATEGY · INTEGRATED 7P MARKETING MIX

Seven Coordinated Programs Addressing Five Prioritized Problems

7P	Projection	Core Strategy	TOWS	Priority
PRODUCT	3.603 → 3.700+	Verified Bioethanol Transparency Program; Vehicle-segment communication; Pump labeling & manufacturer co-endorsement	ST	Medium
PRICE	3.079 → 3.400+	Green Value Guarantee dashboard; First-fill 10–15% trial credit; Motorcycle fixed-price bundle pilot	ST	High
PLACE	3.356 → 3.600+	Java densification to ~1,950 stations (30%); Denpasar/Medan pilots; supply security; MyPertamina real-time locator	SO/WT	High
PROMOTION	2.848 → 3.200+	Always-on digital (IG/YT/TT); 20–30 automotive ambassadors; 500 awareness panels at non-stocking stations	WO	Critical
PEOPLE	3.762 → 3.900+	Ambassador Certification (4-module); Sales-linked incentive & badge; Technical escalation protocol	WO	Medium
PROCESS	3.869 → 4.000+	Proximity push alerts; Green Impact Receipt (CO_2/farmer link); Gamification & pump-screen animation	WO/WT	Med-Low
PHYSICAL EVIDENCE	3.851 → 3.800+	Green Zone 5-element package; Monthly Green Impact Poster; Shared visual ID on awareness panels	SO	Medium

- Promotion is the foundational prerequisite — without awareness, Place/Product/Price improvements cannot generate trial among the 44.4% unaware/untried.
- Place expansion constrained by bioethanol supply (SWOT T3) — supply & distribution commitments must precede or accompany promotional scale-up.

STRATEGY · PRIORITY INTERVENTIONS: PROMOTION & PLACE

Digital-First Promotion + Data-Driven Distribution Densification

PROMOTION (Critical Priority)

1 Always-On Digital Content Program

Monthly content on Instagram, YouTube, TikTok: Green Impact Series, Mojokerto Farmer Series, Engine Truth Series. A/B tested, 3-month production sprint.

2 Automotive Ambassador & Community Program

20–30 creators (5M+ combined reach): mechanics & reviewers > lifestyle influencers. Mass trial events with before/after efficiency measurement.

3 Point-of-Purchase Conversion

Awareness panels + QR at 500 highest-traffic non-stocking stations. MyPertamina contextual push when refueling nearby.

PLACE (High Priority)

1 Data-Driven Java Densification

Distribution Acceleration Task Force (VP Retail Fuel Sales chair). GPS-traffic model ranks stations → target ~1,950 stations (30%) by Month 24.

2 Controlled Non-Java Expansion

Pilots: 5+ stations each in Denpasar & Medan (Month 12–24). Extend only where pilot volume ≥ Java average.

3 Supply Security Before Expansion

Contingency contracts with secondary bioethanol producers + ESDM-authorized ethanol imports as bridge supply (Month 1–6).

4 MyPertamina Green 95 Locator

Real-time stock status locator live by Month 4. Removes off-route deterrence (P3.1 = 2.210).

IMPLEMENTATION · GUARANTEES & PROJECTIONS

Four Structural Guarantees Enable Strategy Execution; 12-Month Targets Set

MANAGEMENT

Green 95 Implementation Committee (Dir. Regional Marketing chair)
Fast-track station approval pathway
Quarterly 7P KPI reviews

Targeted 7P: P3, P4 (all 7Ps)

12-Month KPI: CLI 3.552 → 3.800

HUMAN RESOURCE

Ambassador Certification (mandatory)
Digital Marketing Unit (3–5 FTEs)
Sales-linked incentive scheme

Targeted 7P: P4, P5

12-Month KPI: P5.1 → 3.800
P4 team launched Q2

FINANCIAL

Dedicated RKAP budget line
BPDP-KS/ESDM grant pursuit
Phased capex: Promo/PhysEvid first

Targeted 7P: All 7Ps (Priority P4+P3)

12-Month KPI: Promo budget deployed Q1
Cost per new user tracked

INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY

MyPertamina Green 95 Roadmap (3 phases)
Locator (M4) → Green Impact Receipt (M8)
→ Gamification (M12) + analytics platform

Targeted 7P: P3, P2, P6

12-Month KPI: P6.4 → 3.800
Locator live Month 4

PROJECTED 12-MONTH OUTCOMES (Directional): Overall 7Ps Mean: 3.449 → 3.65–3.70 | Composite Loyalty Index: 3.552 → 3.80 | NPS: −12.1% → Positive Territory

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Q & A

Thank You

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